

The Lullaby River

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Bibi the beaver had too many thoughts. They swirled in her head like leaves in wind. What if it rains tomorrow? What if she forgot something? She felt jittery and buzzy.

Her grandfather took her paw. "Come," he said. "Let us visit the Lullaby River."

They walked through the moonlit woods. Soon they heard it. A gentle river flowed between the trees. It hummed as it moved. La-loo, la-loo, la-loo.



"This river carries worries away," said Grandfather. He picked up a broad green leaf. "Put a worry on this leaf. The river will take it."

Bibi thought of the rain worry. She placed it on the leaf. She set the leaf on the water. It floated away, spinning slowly. The river hummed its song.

"La-loo, la-loo, drift away," sang Grandfather.



Bibi felt a little lighter. She picked up another leaf. She put the forgotten-something worry on it. The leaf bobbed away downstream. The moon shone on the ripples.

"La-loo, la-loo, drift away," sang Grandfather again.

Bibi picked up a third leaf. This time she could not think of a worry. Her head felt quiet. The buzzy thoughts were gone. She placed an empty leaf on the water just for fun.

"La-loo, la-loo, drift away," sang Grandfather one last time.



They sat on the soft riverbank. The water hummed its lullaby. Fireflies danced above the ripples. Bibi leaned against her grandfather. She felt calm and empty in the best way.

Her eyelids grew heavy. The river's song was so gentle. La-loo, la-loo. Bibi's head nodded. Grandfather carried her home, wrapped in his warm coat.

He tucked her into her bark bed. The river's hum seemed to follow them home. It sang through the open window all night long.



Sleep now, little beaver. Your worries have floated far downstream. The river will hum you into the deepest, softest sleep.

***Moral:** You do not have to carry worries to bed; you can let them float away.*

The End